The Modi government identified four major thrust areas in India–Russia relations: 1) remove roadblocks and create new opportunities in defence cooperation, 2) fast-track cooperation in nuclear energy and hydrocarbons to promote India's energy security, 3) strengthen the economic pillar of the relationship, and 4) enrich its political content.

By the time of the 2017 India–Russia Summit, defence cooperation had been put on the fast track. Acquisitions of the S-400 air defence system, missiles, and helicopters were announced. Prime Minister Modi's "Make in India" template was applied to the manufacture of Ka-226 helicopters, building of stealth frigates, and mid-life refit of diesel-electric submarines. India and Russia agreed on a roadmap for long-term defence cooperation, covering joint exercises, exchange of visits, and military training.

An ambitious timetable was agreed upon to establish new nuclear power-generating capacity in India, with at least 10 units to be added in the next two decades. Indian companies invested about USD 5 billion in Siberian oil and gas fields. In September 2017, a consortium led by the Russian oil giant Rosneft acquired a major Indian refinery and port (and a few thousand retail outlets), with an investment of about USD 13 billion, making it Russia's largest overseas investment and India's largest inward investment to date.

Trade promotion initiatives ranged from simplifying customs procedures and synchronising phytosanitary standards to negotiations for a free trade agreement between India and the Eurasian Economic Union (EaEU – comprising Russia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, Armenia, and Kyrgyzstan) and the revival of a 2002 initiative to open up a multimodal trade corridor from India to Russia through Iran. Bilateral joint statements set a target of USD 30 billion for trade in goods and services by 2025 and USD 15 billion each way for investment. Joint research projects in science